

ACLS

ACLS N/A

Buy	\$159.19 ▲ 0.26%	12M Price Target \$180.00	52-Week Range \$58.47 – \$171.61	Market Cap \$4.89B
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ACLS: Golden Cross + Bullish Options Flow; Reiterate Buy

WHAT'S CHANGED

- Technical setup turned constructive: Zacks flagged a Golden Cross (06/03) coinciding with a +5.8% two-day rebound off the \$150.41 support, reclaiming the \$159 handle on elevated 450K volume.
- Options flow decisively bullish (P/C 0.10, 1,147 calls vs 118 puts), offsetting the VP's 2,000-share insider sale narrative; reported 1.1% institutional ownership figure appears stale/anomalous given known Blackrock/Vanguard/FMR stakes totaling ~32%.

IMPLICATIONS

ACLS trading at 89% of its 52-week range with a freshly minted golden cross suggests the market is pricing in stabilization of the silicon carbide ion implant order book that has weighed on shares since 2H25. The Micron comparison piece (05/26) reframes ACLS as a memory/power-semi capex derivative play, which matters given improving DRAM pricing and the WFE recovery narrative. With Industrials/Materials sluggish but semicap-adjacent sentiment improving, the bullish call skew implies positioning ahead of a potential 2H26 SiC restocking cycle or a constructive update at upcoming investor events.

VALUATION

At \$159, ACLS trades ~6.4x EV/Revenue and ~22x forward EV/EBITDA on our FY26E \$760M revenue and ~\$220M EBITDA, in line with the WFE peer median but below high-growth peers like KLAC. Our \$180 PT (~13% upside) assumes mid-cycle EBITDA margins of 26% and 23x multiple, justified by Purion Power leadership in SiC implant. Multiple expansion driver: confirmation of 2027 SiC capacity additions at Wolfspeed/onsemi/STMicro; contraction driver: extended digestion in Chinese mature-node demand.

KEY RISKS

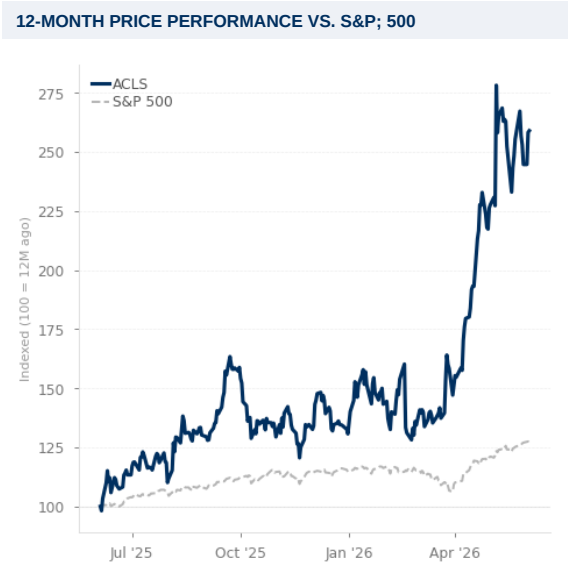
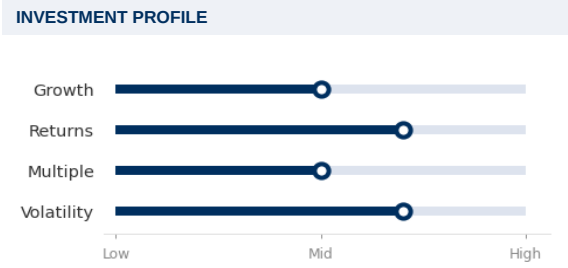
- Silicon carbide capex slowdown — Wolfspeed restructuring and EV demand softness could push SiC implanter orders into 2027.
- China revenue concentration (~45% of recent mix) exposed to export controls and indigenous tool substitution.
- Mature-node memory/logic equipment cyclical — ACLS lacks leading-edge EUV exposure that's driving peer outperformance.

RECENT NEWS

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Key Data	
Price (USD)	\$159.19
12M Price Target	\$180.00
Upside / (Downside)	+13.1%
Market Cap	\$4.89B
FY2026E Revenue	\$760M
FY2027E Revenue	\$880M
FY2026E EPS	\$4.25
FY2027E EPS	\$5.40
Fwd P/E	37.5x



PRICE OUTLOOK — SCENARIO TARGETS BY TIMEFRAME

TIMEFRAME	BULL CASE	BASE CASE	BEAR CASE
1 Month	\$175.00	\$162.00	\$145.00
6 Months	\$195.00	\$175.00	\$135.00
1 Year	\$220.00	\$180.00	\$120.00
2 Years	\$275.00	\$215.00	\$110.00
5 Years	\$400.00	\$290.00	\$130.00
10 Years	\$650.00	\$450.00	\$150.00

SECTOR INTELLIGENCE

HOT SECTORS: Energy (+3.02% 5D), Materials (+0.88% 5D)

COLD SECTORS: Consumer Staples (-2.86% 5D), Real Estate (-2.51% 5D)

ROTATION WATCH: Energy strength and Materials firmness signal reflation/industrial-cycle positioning, historically a leading indicator for semicap equipment orders tied to power/auto end-markets. Defensive bleed (Staples/REITs) suggests risk-on rotation favoring cyclical

BYPRODUCT PLAY: SiC power semi recovery benefits implant tool suppliers asymmetrically; secondary plays include AEHR (test), ENTG (materials), and IPGP (laser processing) as derivatives of the same power-semi capex cycle.

OUTPERFORMERS & PEER CONTEXT

- KLIC (Kulicke & Soffa): Zacks growth coverage (05/19) highlights multiple drivers including advanced packaging — outpacing back-end peers on AI packaging demand.
- MU (Micron): Memory cycle leadership cited as halo trade for ACLS (Motley Fool 05/26); HBM ramp lifting WFE sentiment broadly.

ACLS CONTEXT: ACLS at 89% of 52-week range is outpacing the broader semicap group's recent consolidation, reflecting idiosyncratic optimism on SiC normalization rather than sector beta — relative strength is constructive but narrowly driven.

INVESTMENT STRATEGY

7/10 Conviction Score

Position Size: 2-4% of portfolio

Entry Points: \$148-152 on pullbacks; breakout add above \$172

Time Horizon: 12-24 months

Thesis Invalidation: SiC capex deferrals extending into 2H26 or sustained gross margin <40%

Hedging: Pair short vs AMAT or LRCX; long-dated \$140 puts